

NOVA TECH SOLUTIONS

SAMPLE COMPANY POLICY MANUAL

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Policy Owner: Human Resources Department

Applies To: Employees, interns, contractors, and approved vendors

Classification: Internal Use

1. Purpose

This policy manual establishes standards for workplace conduct, information security, technology use, data protection, attendance, leave, expenses, and incident reporting at Nova Tech Solutions.

The policy is intended to give employees clear and consistent guidance for daily work. Employees are expected to understand the policies that apply to their roles and ask their manager or the responsible department when a requirement is unclear.

This is a fictional sample company policy created for testing a Retrieval-Augmented Generation application. The document contains specific facts, rules, thresholds, dates, responsibilities, and procedures so that a RAG system can be tested for retrieval accuracy.

2. Policy Principles

- Employees must act professionally, ethically, and respectfully.
- Company and customer information must be protected from unauthorized access.
- Company systems must be used responsibly and primarily for legitimate business purposes.
- Security, safety, compliance, and workplace concerns must be reported promptly.
- Managers are responsible for applying policies consistently.
- Employees remain responsible for work produced with the assistance of artificial intelligence tools.

3. Scope

This manual applies to all full-time and part-time employees, interns, contractors, temporary workers, and approved vendors when they are performing work for or representing Nova Tech Solutions.

Where local law or an employment agreement provides a greater employee entitlement or protection, the applicable legal or contractual requirement will take precedence.

4. Workplace Conduct

4.1 Professional Behavior

Employees are expected to communicate respectfully with colleagues, customers, candidates, vendors, and visitors. Discrimination, harassment, bullying, intimidation, threats, retaliation, or deliberately disruptive behavior is prohibited.

Professional communication standards apply to email, meetings, messaging platforms, project-management tools, code reviews, documentation, and company social channels.

4.2 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose situations where personal, financial, or outside business interests could reasonably influence company decisions. Employees involved in procurement or vendor selection must not accept gifts, payments, or benefits that could compromise impartiality.

4.3 Working Hours

The standard working schedule is Monday through Friday, from 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, including a one-hour lunch break. Individual teams may establish different schedules when business requirements or customer support coverage require it.

Employees who expect to be late or absent should notify their manager as early as reasonably possible. Repeated unexplained absence may result in corrective action.

4.4 Remote and Hybrid Work

Employees approved for remote work must maintain a secure workspace and protect company information from unauthorized persons.

- Company laptops must be locked whenever they are unattended.
- Public or shared computers must not be used to access internal administrative systems.
- Confidential files must not be stored in personal cloud drives.
- Employees must use the company VPN when accessing restricted internal resources from untrusted networks.
- Sensitive business discussions should not take place in public locations where they can be overheard.

4.5 Meetings and Communication

Meeting organizers should provide an agenda when practical. Participants are expected to join on time, avoid unnecessary interruptions, and record important decisions in the approved documentation or project-management system.

5. Employee Responsibility

Employees are responsible for reading policies relevant to their work, completing required training, protecting company property, reporting concerns, and following reasonable instructions from authorized managers.

6. Information Security and Technology Use

6.1 Account Security

Every employee must use an individual company account. Passwords must never be shared through email, chat, documents, or verbal communication. Multi-factor authentication is required for systems that support it.

If an employee believes that an account or credential has been compromised, the employee must immediately change the credential where possible and report the incident to the IT Security Team.

6.2 Device Security

- Company-managed devices must run supported operating systems and security software.
- Employees must install security updates within the timeframe communicated by IT.
- USB storage devices from unknown sources must not be connected to company systems.
- Lost or stolen company devices must be reported within 2 hours of discovery.
- Employees must not disable endpoint protection, disk encryption, or security monitoring.

6.3 Acceptable Technology Use

Company technology may be used for legitimate business purposes and limited personal activity that does not interfere with work, violate law, consume excessive resources, or create security risk.

Prohibited activities include unauthorized access attempts, malware distribution, cryptocurrency mining on company resources, bypassing security controls, downloading pirated software, and using company systems to harass or threaten others.

6.4 Software Installation

Employees may install software only through approved channels or with IT approval. Software that has not been reviewed by IT must not be installed on managed company devices.

6.5 Artificial Intelligence Tools

Employees may use approved AI tools for business activities. Before entering company or customer confidential information into an external AI service, employees must confirm that the service is approved for that information classification.

AI-generated code, text, analysis, or recommendations must be reviewed by a qualified employee before being used in production. Employees remain responsible for accuracy, security, licensing, and appropriateness.

6.6 Security Incident Reporting

Potential phishing, accidental data disclosure, unauthorized access, malware, lost devices, or suspicious system behavior must be reported to IT Security as soon as possible.

Employees should preserve relevant evidence and must not intentionally destroy logs, files, or other evidence related to a suspected security incident.

7. Data Protection and Confidentiality

7.1 Information Classification

Company information is divided into four classifications: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted.

Public information includes approved website content, published documentation, and approved press releases. Public information may be shared externally after appropriate approval.

Internal information includes internal procedures, team documentation, and routine operational information. Internal information should normally be shared only with authorized company personnel.

Confidential information includes contracts, business plans, customer records, financial information, and non-public business information. Access must be limited to approved personnel.

Restricted information includes credentials, security keys, highly sensitive personal data, and other information requiring strict access control. Restricted information must be stored using approved security controls and encryption where required.

7.2 Access Control

Access to systems and data must follow the principle of least privilege. Employees receive only the access required for their current responsibilities.

Managers must request access changes when an employee changes role. Access that is no longer required must be removed promptly.

7.3 Offboarding

When employment ends, system access should be disabled at the approved offboarding time. Company equipment, identification cards, documents, and credentials must be returned or revoked as part of the offboarding process.

7.4 Data Retention

Business records must be retained according to the applicable retention schedule. Employees must not intentionally delete records that are subject to an investigation, audit, legal hold, or documented preservation requirement.

7.5 Customer and Personal Data

Customer and employee personal information must be collected only for legitimate business purposes and accessed only by authorized personnel.

Sensitive information must not be copied to personal devices, personal email accounts, or unapproved storage services.

7.6 Confidentiality

Confidential information remains protected during and after employment. Employees must not disclose non-public company information to unauthorized individuals, competitors, friends, family members, or external online communities.

8. Leave and Attendance

8.1 Planned Leave

Planned leave should normally be requested at least 5 business days in advance through the company leave-management system.

Managers should consider project deadlines, customer commitments, team coverage, and previously approved leave when reviewing requests.

8.2 Emergency Absence

Employees experiencing an emergency or unexpected absence should notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible. The employee should provide an expected return date when that information is available.

8.3 Sick Leave

Employees who are unable to work because of illness should notify their manager before the normal start of the working day where practical. Documentation may be requested when permitted by applicable law and company procedures.

9. Business Expenses

9.1 Expense Submission

Reasonable business expenses may be reimbursed when they are necessary, properly documented, and approved according to company procedures.

Expense claims should normally be submitted within 15 calendar days of the expense.

9.2 Receipts

Receipts are required for individual expenses above INR 1,000. Employees should retain receipts and supporting documentation until the claim has been approved.

9.3 Travel Expenses

Business travel should use approved booking channels whenever practical. Personal entertainment, traffic fines, unauthorized upgrades, and expenses unrelated to approved business activity are not reimbursable.

9.4 Expense Accuracy

Employees must submit accurate expense claims. Falsifying receipts, changing amounts, claiming personal purchases as business expenses, or submitting the same expense more than once may result in corrective action.

10. Company Property

Employees are responsible for taking reasonable care of company equipment, identification cards, documents, and other property assigned to them.

Company property must be returned when requested or at the end of employment. Lost or damaged property should be reported promptly.

11. Performance and Corrective Action

Employees are expected to meet role requirements, follow reasonable management instructions, complete assigned work, and participate in performance discussions.

Depending on the circumstances, policy violations may result in coaching, a written warning, suspension, or termination, subject to applicable law and company procedures.

12. Whistleblowing and Non-Retaliation

Employees may raise good-faith concerns about misconduct, fraud, security violations, harassment, safety issues, or policy breaches.

Retaliation against an employee for making a good-faith report or participating in an investigation is prohibited.

13. Policy Exceptions

Policy exceptions must be documented and approved by the responsible department head. Security-related exceptions require IT Security approval.

An exception request should include the reason for the exception, affected systems or teams, duration, and compensating controls.

14. Policy Review and Ownership

The Human Resources Department owns this policy manual and coordinates an annual review.

The IT Security Team may propose immediate revisions when a significant security threat, technology change, or regulatory requirement makes an update necessary.

15. Quick Reference Questions

What are the standard working hours?

Monday through Friday, 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, including a one-hour lunch break.

How early should planned leave normally be requested?

At least 5 business days in advance.

When must a lost company device be reported?

Within 2 hours of discovery.

When should expense claims normally be submitted?

Within 15 calendar days of the expense.

When is a receipt required?

For an individual expense above INR 1,000.

Can confidential information be entered into any AI tool?

No. Employees must use approved AI services and confirm that the service is approved for the relevant information classification.

Who owns the policy?

The Human Resources Department.

How often is the policy reviewed?

At least annually, with earlier review when significant changes require it.

END OF SAMPLE COMPANY POLICY

This fictional document is designed for RAG testing. Its repeated concepts, exact thresholds, responsibilities, dates, and question-answerable facts can be used to evaluate chunking, retrieval, context selection, and generated-answer accuracy.